

Lenovo LOQ

Make way for the new king of budget gaming laptops

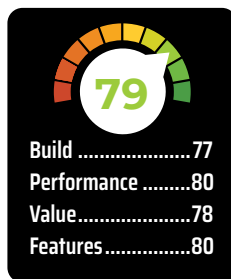
It seems to be a trend of sorts that gaming laptop manufacturers are coming up with new budget laptop series. We've already seen Acer's new Predator Helios Neo 16, and MSI's Cyborg, which both sit snugly in between budget and premium. Now, we have the new Lenovo LOQ lineup from Lenovo which promises to spice things up in the gaming laptop segment. Considering everything the Lenovo LOQ has to offer paired with its pricing starting at 73,990 going up to 99,990 for the top end variant, the Lenovo LOQ just might be the new best budget gaming laptop you can get your hands on. Let's dive into the complete review to find out!



BUILD AND DESIGN

At first glance, the new Lenovo LOQ looks a lot like the refreshed lineup of Lenovo's IdeaPad Gaming 3 from last year. You can clearly see the design inspiration drawn from Lenovo's premium gaming lineup, Legion, as well. In many ways, it makes sense for Lenovo to split IdeaPad and IdeaPad gaming, and it does look like that is what is happening with LOQ, but we don't know for sure yet.

Coming back to the design, the Lenovo LOQ features a fairly subtle design that won't look out of place in a professional setting. It is fairly bulky, which is common with gaming laptops. You've got LOQ emblazoned on the corner of the lid. There's no RGB on anything other than the backlit keyboard, so the laptop as a whole doesn't draw too much attention. You have turquoise accents on both the side and back vents which are trademark IdeaPad Gaming 3;



and the only dash of colour on this otherwise muted device. This increasingly seems to be the preference with more buyers looking for laptops to both work and game on.

Coming to the keyboard, you've got a full-sized keyboard on the Lenovo LOQ,

something we're accustomed to seeing in Lenovo gaming laptops in general. The key travel distance on laptops is something I've never been of a fan of, but the overall typing experience is pleasant, with good spacing and feedback. We would personally prefer using a separate keyboard and mouse and there are more reasons for this which we will get to shortly.

I/O

Coming to I/O options, the LOQ certainly isn't lacking. You have 3x USB-A 3.2 ports (two Gen 2, one Gen 1), 1x USB-C 3.2 Gen 2 port with support

for PD and DisplayPort 1.4, you have an HDMI 2.1 port, an RJ-45 ethernet port, an audio combo jack, a hardware e-shutter switch for the webcam, and the power connector. The only thing missing we'd say is a Thunderbolt port, but we're not really complaining.

PERFORMANCE

With that out of the way we jump straight into the performance. We received the top-end variant of the Lenovo LOQ, which features a 13th gen Intel Core i7-13620H, paired with the NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4060 Laptop GPU with a TGP of 115 W. This is already very impressive if you consider the price tag of Rs 99,990. On paper, this thing already beats everything else in this price range, but let's see how it actually performs.

We'll start things off with the gaming performance, that is after all what you're buying a gaming laptop for, isn't it? It doesn't really come as a surprise, but the RTX 4060 on the Lenovo LOQ gives us the best synthetic and real-world gaming performance numbers we've seen in any gaming laptop under Rs 1 lac.

In our synthetic GPU benchmarks, for which we use 3DMark, the Lenovo LOQ handily beats its competition, which in this price range mostly consists of RTX 4050s and RTX 3060s. We're comparing the benchmark scores of the LOQ with a recent RTX 4050 Laptop GPU and an RTX 3060 Laptop GPU from last year.

The numbers speak for themselves. This continues when we move to real-world gaming performance as well. The Lenovo LOQ is far ahead in all of our real-world gaming tests. You could comfortably play these and newer titles at WQHD and get reasonable FPS numbers. However, do keep the 8GB of VRAM in mind, which is a little on the lower side, if you're planning on playing at higher resolutions.

Next, we come to the processor. The Lenovo LOQ features a 13th gen Intel Core i7-13620H. This processor comes with 10 cores and 16 threads, of which 6 are performance cores and